FOUR CHAIRS

Working Title

EXT. BUILDING - DAY

It's cold.

There are four chairs and three people in front of a door.

The man [RE: Man] and the younger man [RE: student] sit in front of each other. The woman [RE: Supervisor] stands behind the man.

The Supervisor and the Man wear a winter jacket, while the student is in a T-shirt.

The Man and the Student smoke with their head to the ground. The Supervisor is observing the student.

He notices her stare.

STUDENT
What?

SUPERVISOR
Where *the fuck* is your jacket?

SUPERVISOR
Aren't you cold?

The Man snaps back.

The student looks at his arms, notices he has goosebumps.

STUDENT
I am.

MAN
Where's your jacket?

SUPERVISOR
He didn't bring one.

MAN
It's December.

STUDENT
I know that.

SUPERVISOR
Doesn't seem like it.

Man
HEY! What's with the language.

STUDENT
I don't have a jacket.

SUPERVISOR
It's December why is he in a fucking t-shirt?

The Man stands up and turns to her.

The Student throws his cigarette to the ground and stands up.

STUDENT
You know you don't have to always take that tone with me.

MAN
Hey. Come on. She is right. You are not a child, you should think of these things.

STUDENT
Of course. Taking her side.

MAN
I'm not taking any sides.

SUPERVISOR
Just go finish setting up.

The Student looks at the Man. The Man nods.

The Student shakes his head and heads inside.

The Man stands up and turns to the Supervisor.

MAN
He's young.

SUPERVISOR
It's not an age thing. He is not made for this.

MAN
I know.

They head inside.

MAN
You really can't talk to him like that.

STUDENT
I can speak up for myself, you know?

MAN
Shut up and go finish setting up.

The Student throws his cigarette to the ground and heads inside.

STUDENT
This some bullshit.

SUPERVISOR
Hey!

MAN
Let him go.

The Student enters the building.

MAN
What the fuck was that?

SUPERVISOR
He should have his jacket.

MAN
Well he didn't bring, so what now?

She scoffs and heads inside. He follows her.

INT. ROOM - CONTINUOUS

There is a BLACK HOLE LEVITATING IN THE MIDDLE OF THE ROOM. It doesn't emit any sound, it doesn't move.

On the right a large table is crowded with all sorts of science equipment.

The Student is kneeled at a safe distance across from it. He is setting up McGuffin #1 behind an orange tape line.

MAN
Is it ready?

The student turns to them, tilts his head.

STUDENT
Yeah?

SUPERVISOR
Are you confused about it?

STUDENT
I didn't set it up.

MAN
So it's not ready.

STUDENT
No. It's ready. It's already been calibrated.

SUPERVISOR
Do you even know how?

STUDENT
I do not.

SUPERVISOR
(whispered)
Just go check it out.

The Man approaches the Student.

We stay on the Supervisor. Her attention diverts to the table. Something doesn't add up.

CLOSE ON STUDENT AND MAN

The man kneels next to the Student to observe McGuffin #1.

MAN
Let's see.

The man starts doing [INSERT SCIENCY THINGY]. We notice his right hand is MISSING the PINKY.

STUDENT
By the way I never asked you what happened there.

MAN
Where?

The Student nods to Man's hand. The Man doesn't understand.

STUDENT
Your pinky. How'd you lose it?

The Man looks down at his own hand.

MAN
Wha- It's just the way it is.

STUDENT
Does it ever hurt?

The man closes his fist, closely observing his four fingers.

SUPERVISOR (O.C.)
What the fuck is this?

The man and the student turn to the supervisor. She is holding a TAPE RECORDER.

The man and the student stand up.

MAN
What about it?

SUPERVISOR
Did you play it?

STUDENT
Why would we play it? We the ones doing the recording.

SUPERVISOR
You are fucking with it, aren't you? You are fucking with me. You always are.

MAN
Nora. You need to calm down.

SUPERVISOR
I need to- Sure. Listen to this. This little shit is fucking with me.

She plays the tape. *[Text in italic is on tape].*

MAN
First week of observation failed to produce any conclusive results.

STUDENT
First week?

MAN
The anomaly doesn't appear to weigh anything as well as it doesn't show any signs of emitting nor absorbing or attracting anything.

The tape keeps playing with no voice on it.

MAN
Exactly.

The tape keeps playing. No voice. On the tape we hear the Supervisor and the Man laughing thunderously.

SUPERVISOR
(catching her breath)
Alright. Alright. All jokes aside. This anomaly might be a unicum in human history. We may have never seen anything like this before.

The Supervisor stops the recording.

MAN
How did you do this?

STUDENT
Do what?

SUPERVISOR
You understand you are fucking done, right?

She starts going through the table.

SUPERVISOR (CONT'D)
Four cups, four pairs of gloves.

She points in a corner.

SUPERVISOR (CONT'D)
Those random shoes. What else do you have in your backpack? A fourth toothbrush? It doesn't even make sense.

She lifts her right hand. She is wearing a wedding ring.

SUPERVISOR
Did you put this on me in my sleep? That's sick. You couldn't even bother to put *any* initials on it? Just mine? That's not how wedding rings work. You are supposed to be a PhD student, dumbass.

STUDENT
What in the actual fuck are you talking about?

As the Supervisor and the Student keep arguing the Man looks back down at his four fingers.

MAN
Nora, how many fingers do I have?

SUPERVISOR
What?

MAN
On my right hand. How many fingers?

SUPERVISOR
What kind of question is that?

MAN
We've known each other 20 years.
It's a simple question.

He raises his hands. Showing the four fingers.

She steps back.

MAN
There are four chairs outside,
Nora.

SUPERVISOR
It's not possible.

MAN
The McGuffin #1 was calibrated
already.

The three of them look at each other and distance themselves from one another. They turn to the black hole.

The McGuffin #1 flares up.

Nora drops to her knees.

She starts screaming her lungs out.

CAMERA PANS OUT.

THE END.